



BELLS UP AI

Bells Up AI Brand Guidelines

May 2026

What is “Bells Up”?

In orchestral music, the French horn is typically played with the bell facing away: warm, blended, restrained. But sometimes the composer writes bells up. The players raise their instruments and the sound transforms: direct, clear, impossible to ignore.

That is the idea behind Bells Up AI. Small firm lawyers have been quietly doing exceptional work with limited tools. It is time to raise the bell.

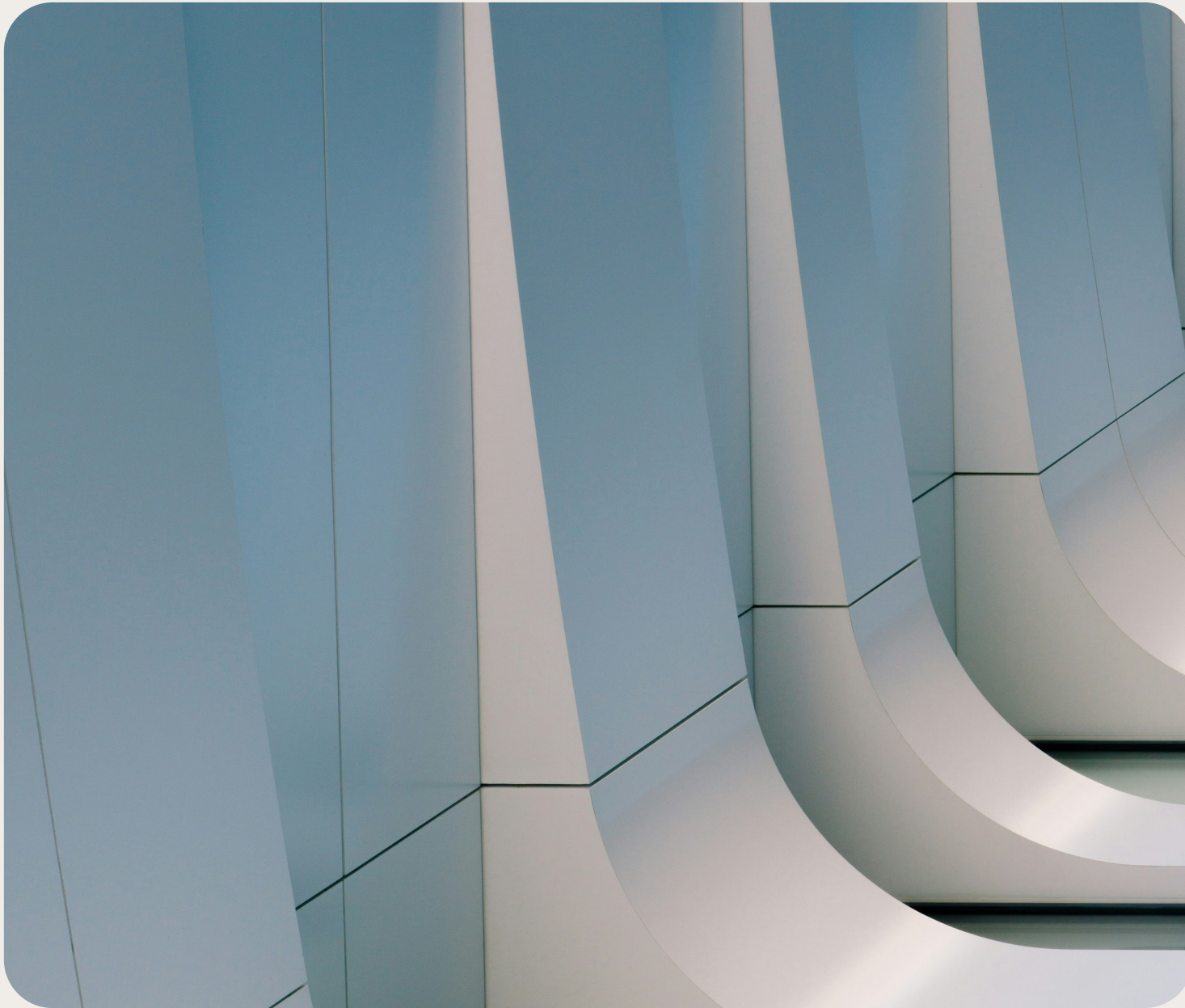


Contents

Overview	1
Brand Architecture	5
Logo Usage	7
Typography	11
Color Palette	14
Graphic Language	16
Photography	19
Motion Guide	21
Interface Design System	23
Prescriptive Formats	28
Governance	34

PART 1

Overview



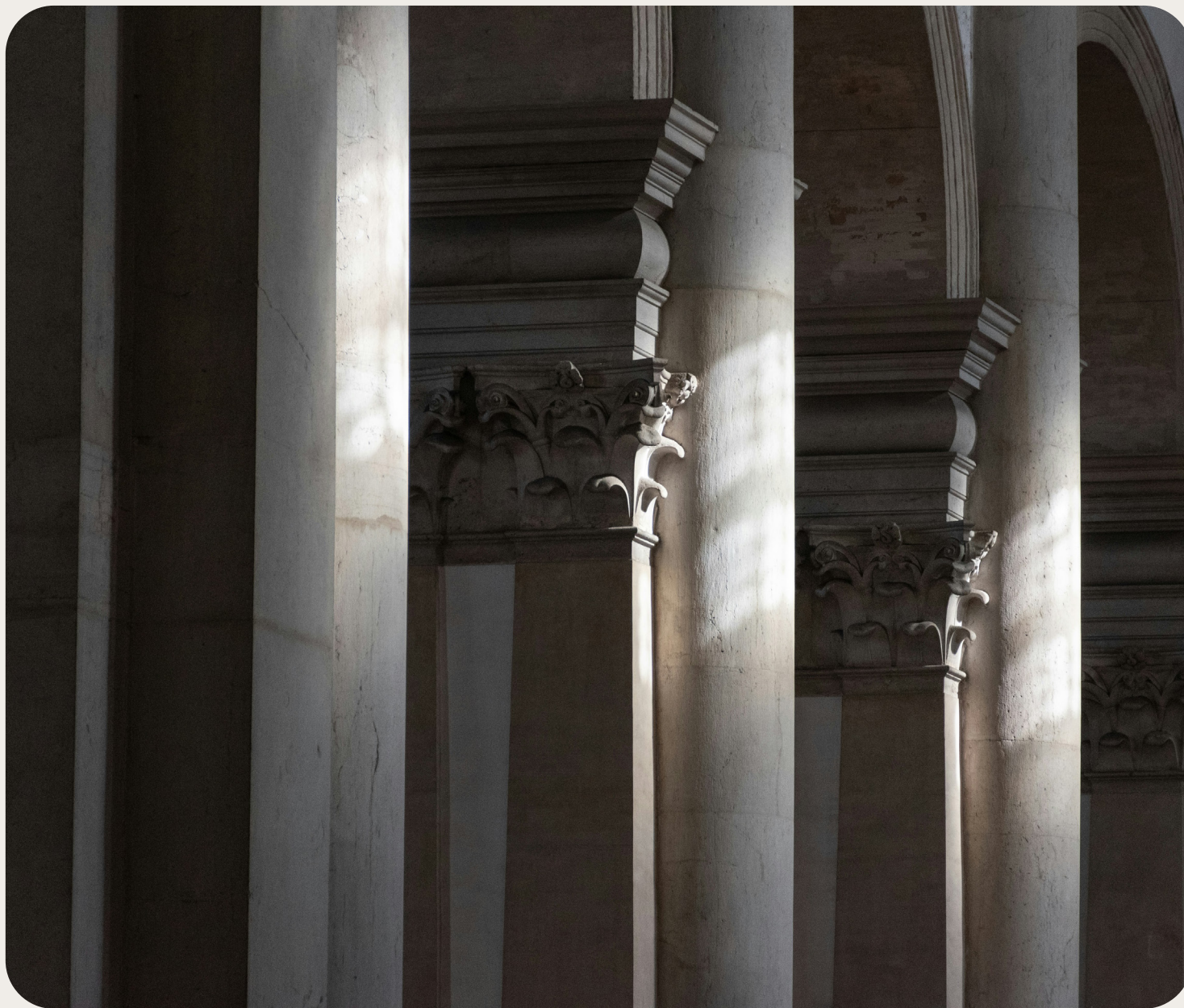
Purpose

Bells Up AI develops AI tools for legal professionals with an emphasis on usability, confidentiality, workflow integration, and operational clarity. The brand system is designed to position the company within a legal and professional-services context rather than within consumer or speculative technology aesthetics. The identity prioritizes credibility, legibility, precision, and long-term recognition.

Brand Positioning

The brand is positioned between legal infrastructure, editorial systems, enterprise software, and institutional communications. The visual language intentionally avoids speculative futurism, decorative AI imagery, excessive motion, entertainment-oriented aesthetics, and high-saturation technology palettes. Instead, the system emphasizes clarity, restraint, structure, consistency, information hierarchy, and trust signaling.





Strategic Objectives

The identity system is designed to build trust with legal professionals and potential clients, reduce perceived technological risk, support understanding of complex systems, and reinforce operational credibility across all brand touch points. The system should position Bells Up AI as a reliable and professional AI platform for sensitive legal workflows.

PART 2

Brand Architecture

Core Brand Themes



Amplification

The “bells up” reference functions as a metaphor for increased clarity, projection, and presence. The concept is directional rather than decorative and informs the communication strategy, motion language, and visual system structure.



Precision

The system favors measured typography, structured layouts, and controlled contrast over expressive visual treatments. Visual restraint is used to reinforce competence and consistency.



Accessibility

Information architecture and messaging prioritize comprehension across technical and non-technical audiences. The goal is to reduce friction while preserving technical credibility.



Trust

The visual system supports perceptions of reliability, confidentiality, governance awareness, and institutional maturity through consistency, typography, spacing, and restrained visual behaviors.

PART 3

Logo Usage

Primary Mark

The primary identity consists of the symbol, wordmark, and horizontal lockup. The preferred application is the horizontal lockup because it provides the strongest balance of recognition, scalability, and clarity across digital and presentation environments.

Primary Logo Color



Primary Logo Black



Symbol Color



Symbol Black



Primary Logo Reverse



Primary Logo White



Symbol Reverse



Symbol White



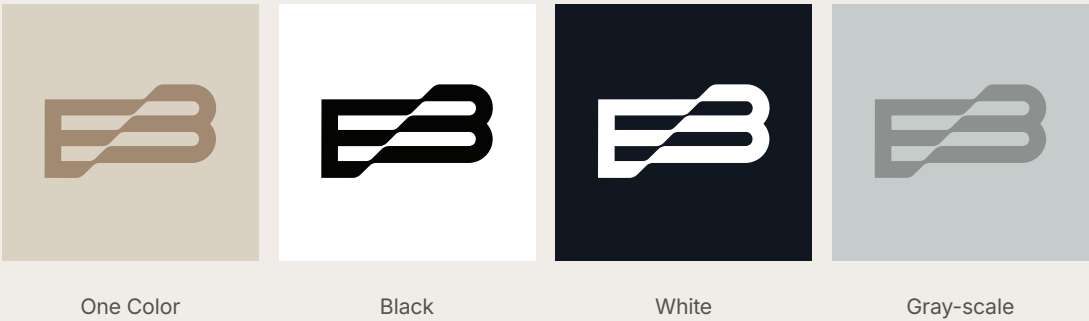
Symbol Logic

The symbol is designed for clarity across interfaces, presentations, and compact digital applications. Geometric consistency and controlled negative space support legibility, scalability, and reliable monochrome reproduction.

SCALABILITY

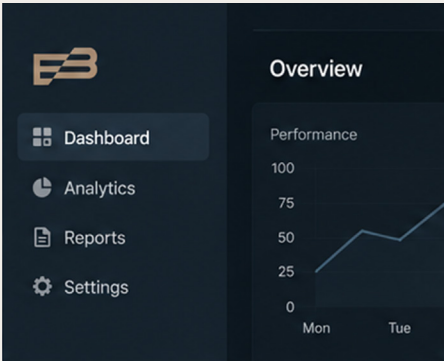


MONOCHROME REPRODUCTION

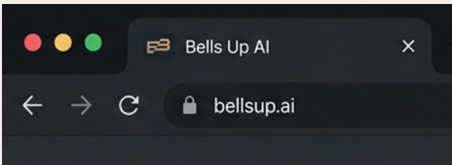


APPLICATION EXAMPLES

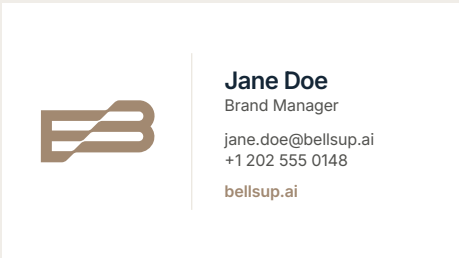
Software Interface



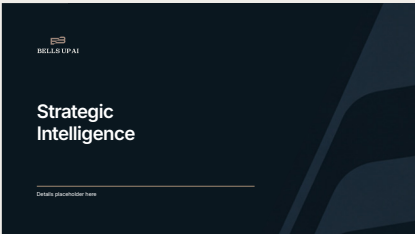
Favicon



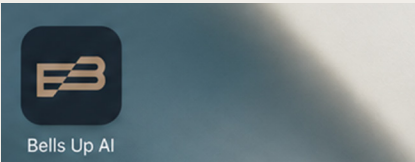
Email Signature



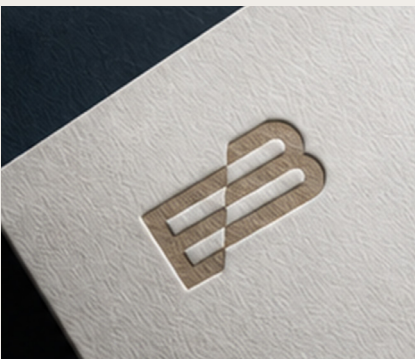
Presentation Theme



Mobile App Icon



Print Application



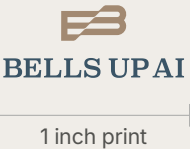
Clear Space

Minimum clear space equals the height of the “B” within the wordmark. No typography, imagery, or graphic elements should enter this protected area.



Minimum Size

For digital environments, the logo should never appear smaller than 120 pixels wide. For print applications, the minimum width is one inch to preserve legibility and form integrity.



Improper Use

The logo may not be distorted, outlined, rotated, stretched, shadowed, gradient-filled, or placed on low-contrast backgrounds. Consistency in reproduction is critical to maintaining recognition and institutional trust.



PART 4

Typography

Typography

The typography system combines serif typography for hierarchy and emphasis with sans-serif typography for functional communication. This creates distinction from the dominant AI branding pattern, which relies heavily on neutral sans-serif systems. The serif component introduces editorial reference, institutional tone, visual contrast, and memorability. The sans-serif component supports interface clarity, accessibility standards, technical legibility, and responsive scalability.

Inter SemiBold

Primary Typeface

Inter is used for headings, hero messaging, navigation, interfaces, and primary communication across digital and presentation environments. Recommended weights are Regular, Medium, and SemiBold. Excessive weight variation should be avoided to maintain visual consistency and typographic restraint. The typeface was selected for clarity, spacing consistency, screen optimization, and functional neutrality. Its role is structural, direct, and highly legible across interfaces and communication systems.

Source Serif 4

Secondary Typeface

Source Serif 4 is used selectively for editorial emphasis, pull quotes, strategic statements, and long-form communication requiring a more institutional or publishing-oriented tone. Recommended weights are Regular and Medium. The serif system reinforces the brand's connection to legal communication, editorial environments, and structured written language rather than conventional consumer technology aesthetics.

Type Scale

The type scale uses a Major Third ratio to maintain proportional consistency across responsive environments. The scale establishes hierarchy through measured progression rather than dramatic jumps in size.

Typographic Rules

Headlines should remain concise and typically fall between one to four words. Body copy should prioritize scanning efficiency, controlled line lengths, short paragraph structures, and consistent hierarchy.

Dense text blocks, excessive emphasis styling, centered long-form copy, and inconsistent spacing should be avoided. Hierarchy should primarily be established through scale, spacing, and alignment rather than decorative typography treatments.

TYPE SCALE: MAJOR THIRD

3.815 rem	H1 Heading
3.052 rem	H2 Heading
2.441 rem	H3 Heading
1.953 rem	H4 Heading
1.563 rem	H5 Heading
1.25 rem	H6 Heading
1 rem	P body text
.8 rem	Small text

PART 5

Color Palette

Color Palette

Navy functions as the primary emphasis color and carries the greatest visual authority within the system. Slate and Dust support hierarchy, layering, and interface structure, while Glacier Gray provides a neutral supporting tone.

Cloud serves as the primary background color and creates spacious, low-noise environments. Light Tan and Taupe introduce warmth without increasing saturation. Graphite provides structural contrast, while Charcoal is reserved for high-emphasis surfaces and dark applications.

Large fields of saturated color, excessive gradients, and unnecessary visual effects are discouraged in order to preserve clarity, consistency, and reduce visual fatigue.



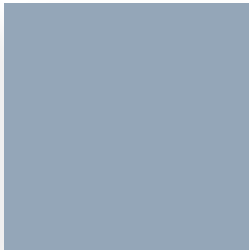
Charcoal
HEX #101720
RGB 16 23 32
CMYK 82 72 59 75
PANTONE BLACK 6 C



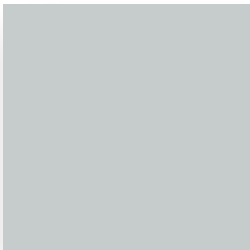
Navy
HEX #142636
RGB 20 38 54
CMYK 89 74 53 60
PANTONE 7546 C



Slate
HEX #3B5466
RGB 59 84 102
CMYK 80 60 43 24
PANTONE 5405 C



Dust
HEX #94A6B8
RGB 148 166 184
CMYK 44 28 20 0
PANTONE 7543 C



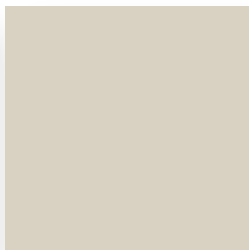
Glacier Gray
HEX #C6CCCC
RGB 198 204 204
CMYK 22 14 16 0
PANTONE 14-4102 TPG



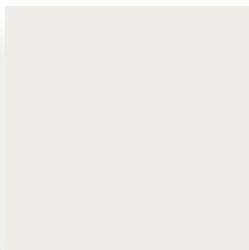
Graphite
HEX #52524F
RGB 82 82 79
CMYK 64 56 58 34
PANTONE 424 C



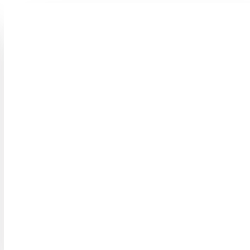
Taupe
HEX #A18972
RGB 161 137 114
CMYK 37 42 56 6
PANTONE 17-1319



Light Tan
HEX #D9D1C2
RGB 217 209 194
CMYK 14 14 22 0
PANTONE 7527 C



Cloud
HEX #F0EEE9
RGB 240 238 233
CMYK 0 13 6
PANTONE 11-4201



Bright White
HEX #FFFFFF
RGB 255 255 255
CMYK 0 0 0 0
PANTONE 11-0601 TCX

PART 6

Graphic Language

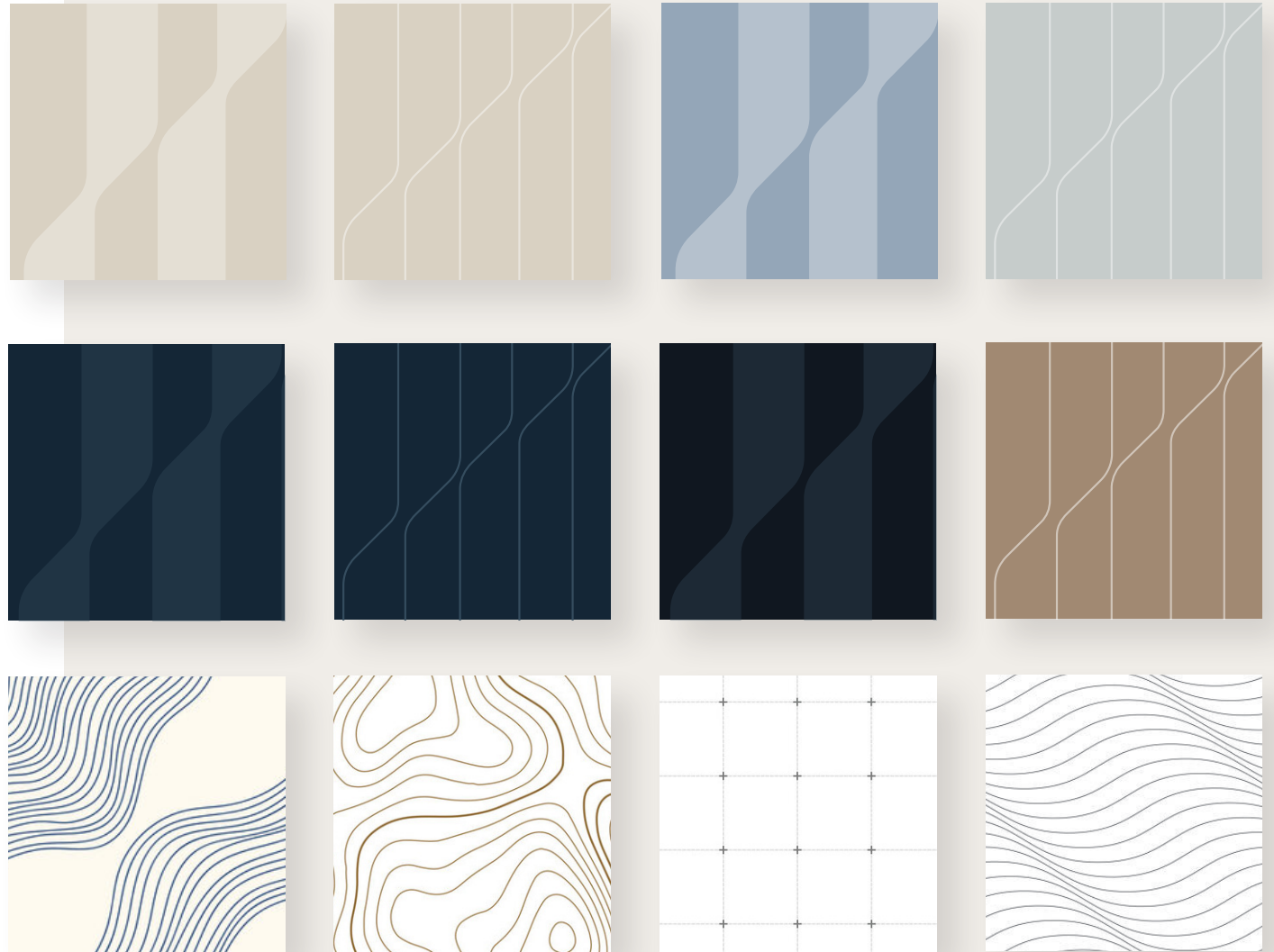
Visual Direction

The graphic system references resonance, directional movement, signal amplification, spatial fields, and acoustic structures. Abstract visual systems should suggest intelligence and precision without relying on literal AI imagery or startup conventions.

Approved Graphic Treatments

Recommended treatments include waveform structures, contour mapping, directional line systems, restrained gradients, geometric interference patterns, grid frameworks, and thin-line motion systems.

Robotic imagery, glowing circuitry, literal neural networks, holographic effects, stock AI visuals, and decorative data streams should be avoided, as they reduce differentiation and introduce category clichés.



Iconography

System Principles

Icons should feel architectural, restrained, and precise. The system should prioritize clarity, geometric consistency, and low visual noise. Icons should support hierarchy rather than dominate layouts and should remain consistent across interfaces, dashboards, and presentations. Avoid decorative styles, multicolor systems, excessive detail, emoji-like expressions, skeuomorphic rendering, and generic AI symbols. The system should feel informed by architectural signage, technical diagrams, and Swiss interface design.

Material Symbols Settings

Style: Rounded

Fill: 0

Weight: 200

Grade: 0

Optical Size: 48px

Color: #A18972

[Link here to Google Material Symbols >>](#)



PART 7

Photography

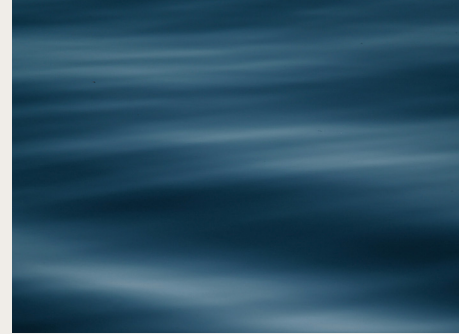
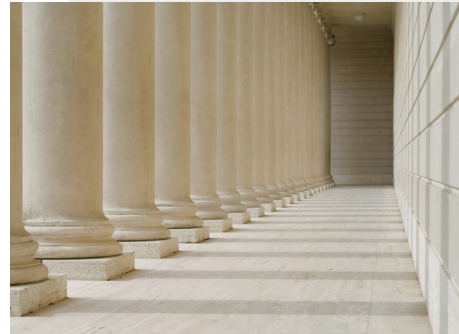
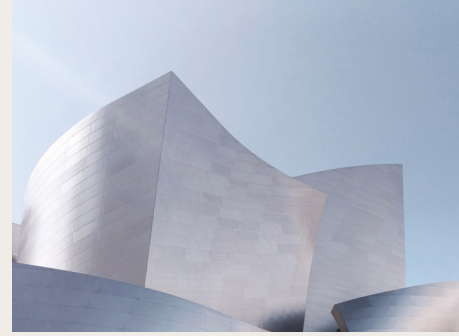
Photography Strategy

Photography should support realism, operational context, environmental credibility, stability, and professionalism. Images should appear observational rather than staged and should reinforce trust through authenticity, restraint, and structural composition. Architecture, light, and spatial form can be used to communicate permanence, precision, and institutional credibility.

Preferred Subjects

Recommended subjects include architectural forms, columns, structural details, professional environments, workspace materials, contextual product usage, and restrained environmental imagery.

Exaggerated emotional expressions, overly stylized AI imagery, generic corporate stock photography, and artificial futuristic environments should be avoided because they conflict with the brand's institutional positioning.



PART 8

Motion Guide

Motion Principles

Motion should reinforce continuity, clarity, responsiveness, and spatial structure.

Animation timing should remain restrained and should support comprehension rather than visual spectacle. The system should feel deliberate and controlled.

Approved Motion Behaviors

Recommended motion behaviors include fades, directional transitions, layered depth movement, subtle parallax, and progressive reveal systems.

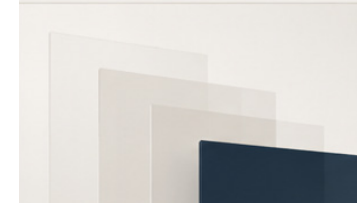
Bounce animations, exaggerated easing, decorative transitions, and high-frequency movement should be avoided because they reduce perceived precision and increase cognitive noise.



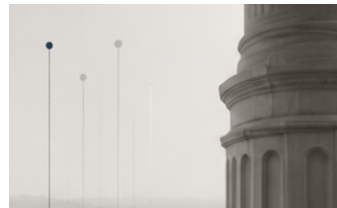
Fades



Smooth directional



Layered depth movement



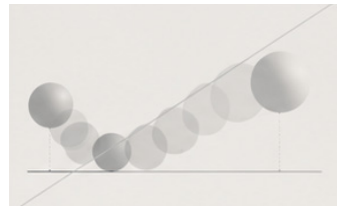
Parallax



Progressive reveal



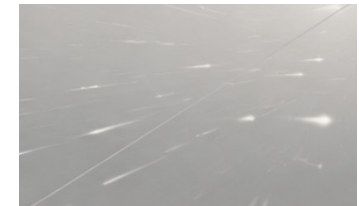
Subtle animated text



Avoid bounce animation



Avoid exaggerated motion



Avoid high-frequency movement

PART 9

Interface Design System

Grid Structure

The layout system uses a 12-column responsive grid with modular spacing and controlled alignment logic. The grid prioritizes readability, information grouping, scanning behavior, and structural consistency across interfaces and communications. The system should feel ordered and intentional rather than decorative.

12-COLUMN RESPONSIVE GRID



Margin: 80 px
Max width: 1440 px
Column: 1fr
Gutter: 24 px

Spacing System

Whitespace functions as a structural component rather than empty space. The system should maintain generous vertical spacing, predictable alignment relationships, and consistent padding intervals to reduce visual congestion and improve comprehension. Spacing should reinforce hierarchy before additional visual styling is introduced.

Alignment Rules

Left alignment is preferred for body copy, interfaces, forms, and presentation systems because it improves readability and scanning behavior. Centered alignment should be reserved for isolated emphasis moments such as hero statements or short-form messaging. Alignment consistency is prioritized over visual novelty.

VERTICAL RHYTHM EXAMPLE

OVERVIEW

Built for clarity. Designed for impact.

Placeholder text. Whitespace functions as a structural component rather than empty space. The system should maintain generous vertical spacing, predictable alignment relationships, and consistent padding intervals to reduce visual congestion and improve comprehension. Spacing should reinforce hierarchy before additional visual styling is introduced.

Button

CONTAINER PADDING EXAMPLE

32 px

Card Title

Placeholder text. Whitespace functions as a structural component rather than empty space. The system should maintain generous vertical spacing, predictable alignment relationships, and consistent padding intervals to reduce visual congestion and improve comprehension. Spacing should reinforce hierarchy before additional visual styling is introduced.

READ MORE >>

32 px

32 px

32 px

Design System

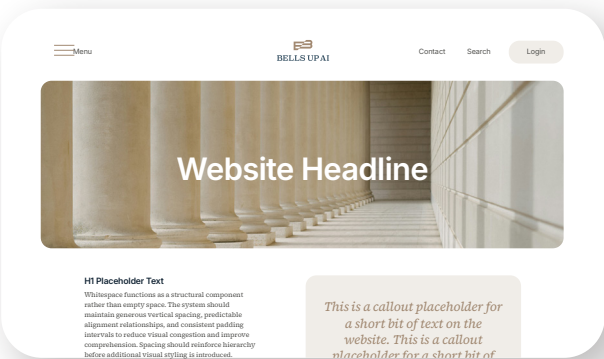
Interface Principles

Interfaces should prioritize legibility, hierarchy, predictability, and low cognitive load. The system should feel structured, calm, and technically competent, communicating operational maturity through consistency rather than stylistic complexity.

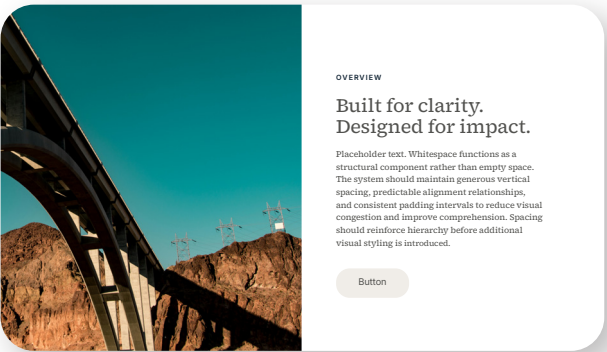
Components & Interaction

Components should maintain consistent spacing, restrained shadows, limited color variance, and typography-led hierarchy. Buttons should prioritize accessibility, clarity, and touch-target consistency. Forms should use clear labels, logical grouping, and visible validation states. Tables should rely on alignment, spacing, restrained rule lines, and minimal styling to support information clarity.

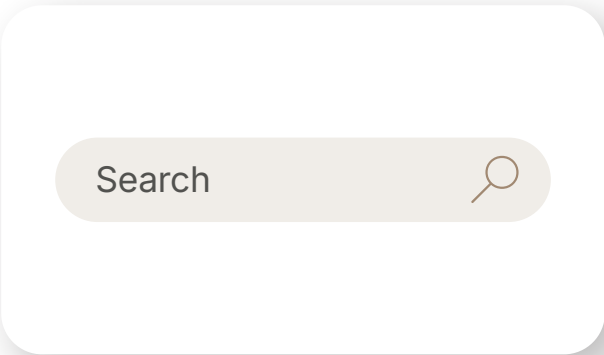
INTERFACE EXAMPLE



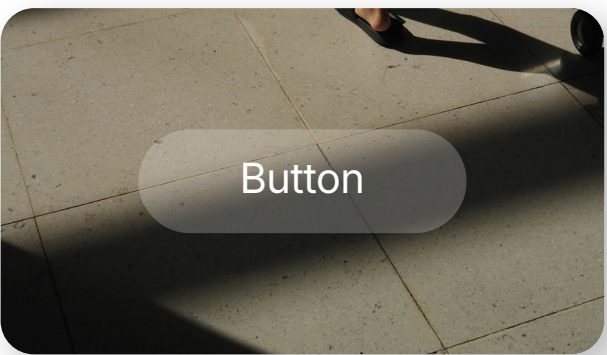
HORIZONTAL COMPONENT EXAMPLE



SEARCH BAR EXAMPLE



REVERSE BUTTON EXAMPLE



Web Architecture

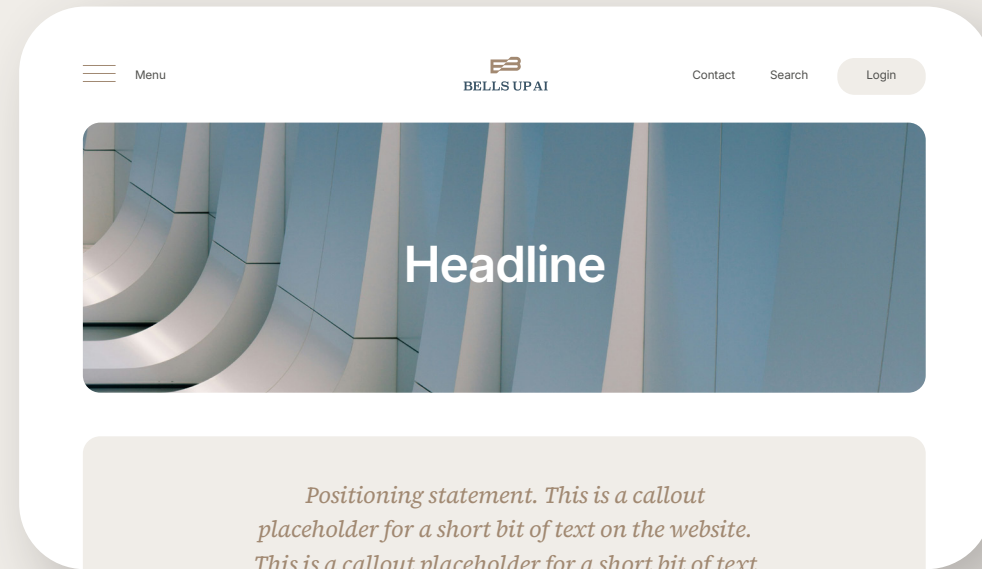
Primary page types include the homepage, product detail pages, pricing, security and compliance, blog, webinar landing pages, resources, contact, and demo scheduling. The system should support scalability across marketing, product education, and operational communications.

Web Typography

Inter should establish hierarchy through scale, spacing, and weight. Interfaces should maintain generous margins, controlled reading widths, and restrained visual density to support readability and clarity.

Accessibility

The web system should meet WCAG AA standards and maintain semantic HTML structure, keyboard accessibility, responsive behavior, and readable typography across environments. Accessibility is treated as a foundational design requirement.



Homepage Structure

The homepage should prioritize clear positioning, product comprehension, workflow explanation, trust signals, customer outcomes, and a focused call to action. The structure should emphasize clarity and progressive disclosure over promotional density.

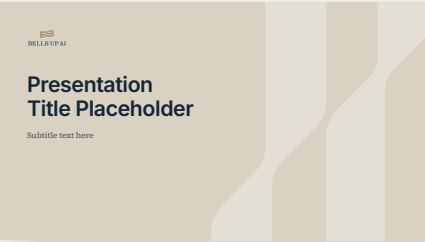
PART 10

Prescriptive Formats

Presentation System

Layouts should prioritize modular composition, hierarchy contrast, reduced text density, and spacing consistency. Presentation systems should remain readable in both large-scale projection environments and virtual screen-share settings.

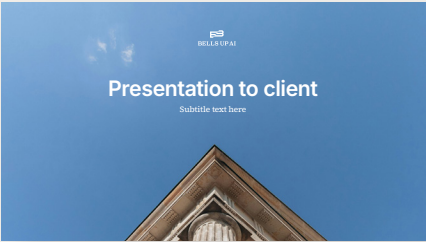
Cover Light



Cover Dark



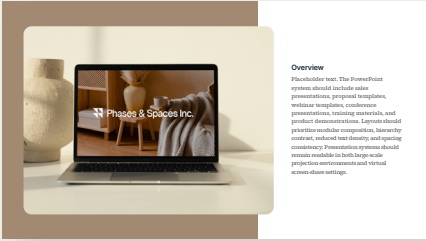
Pitch



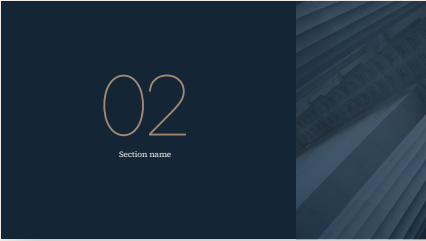
Training



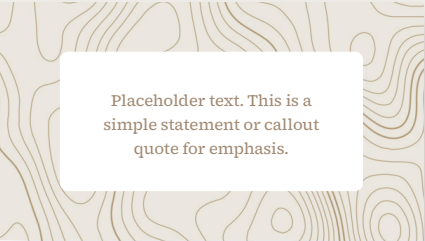
Product Demos



Section Divider



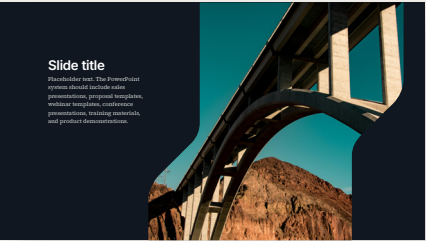
Statement



End Slide



Image Slide



Document Templates

Required document systems include proposal templates, statements of work, white papers, case studies, legal summaries, and one-page overviews.

Document layouts should maintain consistent margins, restrained hierarchy, and typography-led organization.

Proposal Cover Simple



Proposal Cover With Photo



Update or Article



Overview Sheet



Pitch Cover



Case Study



Social Templates

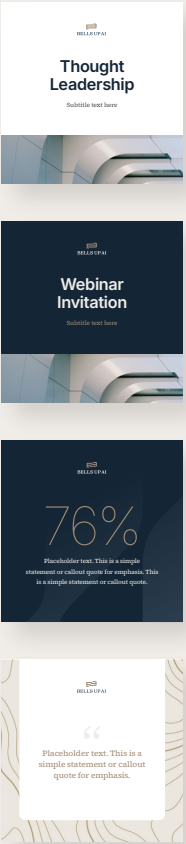
The social system should include LinkedIn carousels, announcement graphics, webinar promotions, quote systems, and thought leadership formats. Videos and carousels are recommended over static posts.

The visual behavior should remain aligned with the broader identity system and avoid trend-based social media aesthetics.

Carousels



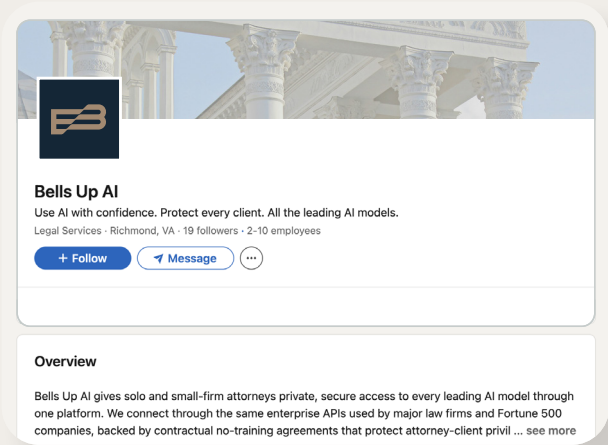
Static Posts



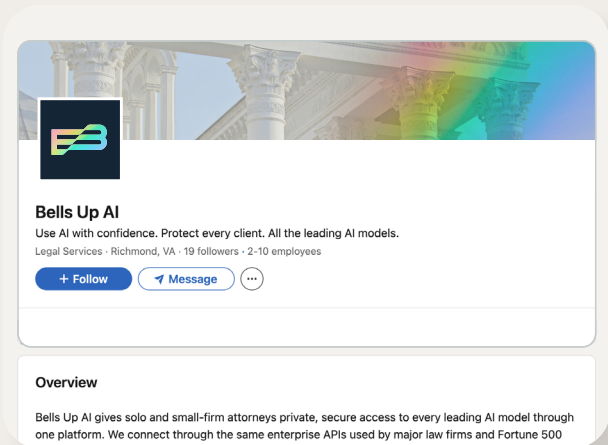
Profile and Hero Images

The profile image should remain fixed as the standalone “B” symbol to maintain legibility and recognition at small digital sizes where the full wordmark loses readability. Hero images may evolve over time for campaigns or announcements, but should remain minimal, editorial, and aligned with the broader identity system. Typography should generally be avoided within hero images because platform cropping and responsive scaling can cut off content unpredictably, reducing clarity and creating an inconsistent appearance across devices.

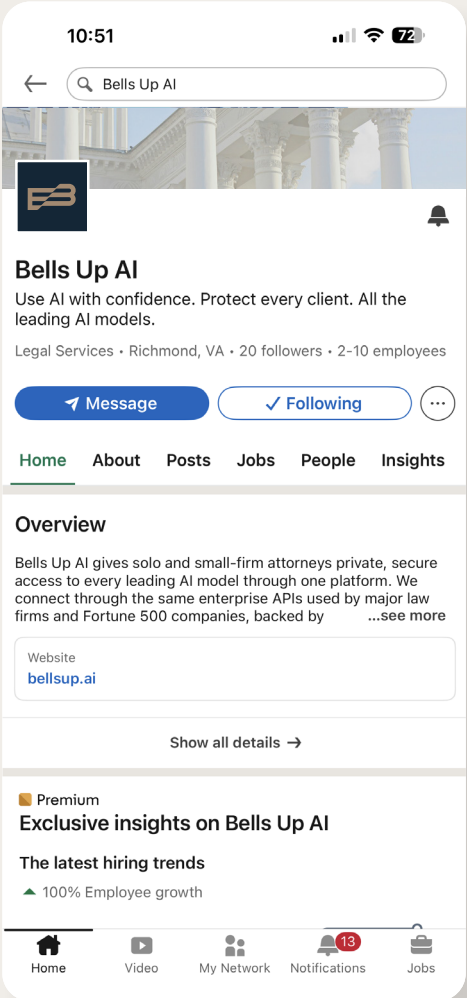
Sample LinkedIn Hero and Profile Photo



Sample Hero Campaign (Pride)



Mobile View



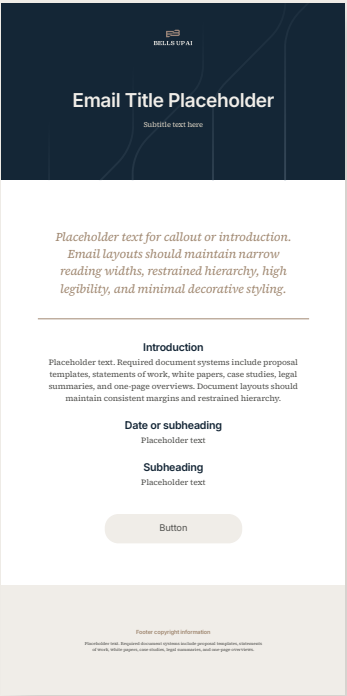
Email System

The email system should include newsletters, onboarding emails, webinar invitations, event communications, and product updates. Layouts should maintain narrow reading widths, restrained hierarchy, high legibility, and minimal decorative styling.

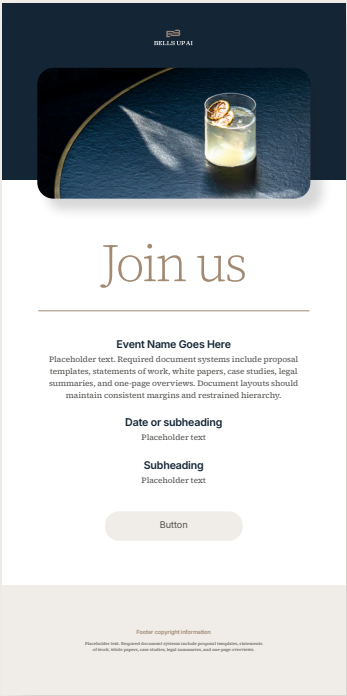
Product Templates

Recommended systems include dashboard components, onboarding flows, AI response modules, workflow panels, document summaries, empty states, and research interfaces. The product system should maintain consistency with the broader identity framework while supporting functional clarity and scalability. The system is available on the website as HTML and CSS components in the index file.

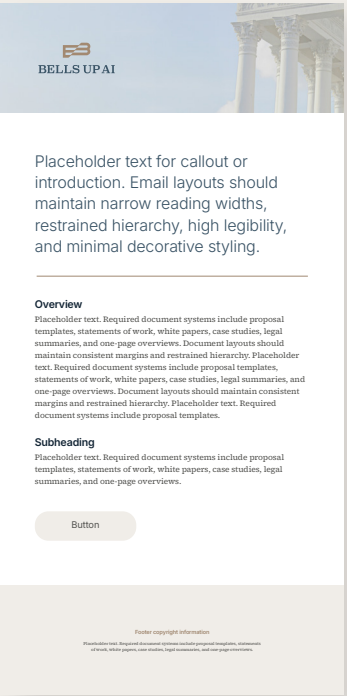
Standard Email



Email Invitation



Article Email



PART 11

Governance

Brand Consistency

The identity system should maintain consistency across typography, spacing, hierarchy, interaction behavior, and tone across all environments. Applications should be evaluated for clarity, accessibility, visual consistency, and communication effectiveness rather than stylistic novelty.

The system is designed to communicate operational reliability, technical precision, and long-term credibility while remaining adaptable across evolving platforms and communication formats.





BELLS UP AI